CMS · NANOAOD · TRIGGER OBJECTS · DETAILED WALKTHROUGH

# Why the unseeded diphoton leg has no NanoAOD filter bits, from the HLT menu to the fix

Thirty-one slides with the real code at each step: the HLT path and its filters, the trigger summary, PAT and MiniAOD, the NanoAOD table producer and its selection string, the scope across every NanoAOD version and every menu since 2018, a scan of the whole trigger-object table, and the one-line fix with its validation.

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Sources: cms-sw/cmssw master ed35654b1, CMSSW_13_3_1_patch1 (NanoAOD v13), release branches 12_4_X to 16_1_X, HLT menus 2018 to 2026

`TrigObj_filterBits · bits 16, 17 (v15) · 14, 15 (v12 to v14)`

# The problem in one page

**3**

photon filter bits documented but impossible to set (16, 17, 19 in v15; 14, 15, 17 in v12 to v14)

**4+**

NanoAOD versions affected: v12, v13, v14, v15 and everything after, including today's master

**19**

HLT menu files checked, 2018 to 2026: same filter names, same collections, same chain everywhere

**1**

line to change in triggerObjects_cff.py, mirroring what the Electron selection has done since 2023

## Problem

The Photon entry of the NanoAOD trigger-object table only accepts HLT objects from the collection hltEgammaCandidates. The sub-leading leg of HLT_Diphoton30_22_R9Id_OR_IsoCaloId_AND_HE_R9Id_Mass90 and _Mass95 is built from hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded. The collection test is applied before the filter bits are computed, so every object carrying the unseeded last-filter labels is dropped and its bits can never appear. The sub-leading photon of the main H to gamma gamma triggers cannot be trigger-matched from NanoAOD. Confirmed on thirteen NanoAOD files from v9 to v15 and 2026 data (16_0_X): not a single photon object with an unseeded bit.

## Solution

Accept both e/gamma collections in the Photon selection string, exactly as the Electron selection does. Because objects are kept only when they set at least one photon bit, and the only photon-bit filters on the unseeded collection are the three diphoton ones, the output changes only in events that fired those triggers. Bit numbers and documentation stay the same. NANO re-made with the fix sets the unseeded bits in all 10453 Mass90 events of the MC test file and changes nothing else; in 2026 data (16_0_4_patch2) in all 308. The fix branch is on the fork; no pull request is open yet.

# What a NanoAOD trigger object is, and how analyses use the filter bits

| branch | meaning |
|---|---|
| TrigObj_id | object type: 11 electron, 22 photon, 13 muon, 15 tau, 1 jet, 6 fat jet, 2 MET, 3 HT, 4 MHT |
| TrigObj_pt, eta, phi | the HLT object's kinematics (for e/gamma: the supercluster) |
| TrigObj_l1pt, l1iso, l1charge | the matched L1 seed within a cone (type -98 for e/gamma) |
| TrigObj_l2pt | the matched L2 object where configured (muons, jets, MET) |
| TrigObj_filterBits | one bit per HLT filter the object passed, from a per-type list in triggerObjects_cff.py; 32-bit up to 15_0_1, 64-bit from 15_0_2 |

```
# sketch of a typical NanoAOD trigger match (awkward)
to   = events.TrigObj
ph   = to[to.id == 22]
leg2 = ph[(ph.filterBits >> 17) & 1 == 1]
# unseeded R9 leg: always empty today
dr   = photons.metric_table(leg2)
ok   = ak.any(dr < 0.1, axis=2)
```

A leg-by-leg efficiency, a trigger-matched tag-and-probe, or a HiggsDNA-style matching of both photons needs the bit of the last filter of each leg. For the sub-leading leg of the diphoton triggers that bit is never set, so the match always fails.

The table is produced by TriggerObjectTableProducer from the unpacked MiniAOD trigger objects. Each object type has its own selection string; an object is written only if it passes that string and sets at least one bit of that type.

# Two e/gamma candidate collections at HLT: L1-seeded and unseeded

### hltEgammaCandidates (seeded)

Superclusters built only in regions around L1 e/gamma candidates. Used by the leading leg (Et > 30 GeV, L1 match required) and by nearly every single-photon and single-electron path.

```
fragment.hltEgammaCandidates = cms.EDProducer(
  "EgammaHLTRecoEcalCandidateProducers",
  scHybridBarrelProducer = cms.InputTag(
    'hltParticleFlowSuperClusterECALL1Seeded',
    'hltParticleFlowSuperClusterECALBarrel' ),
  scIslandEndcapProducer = cms.InputTag(
    'hltParticleFlowSuperClusterECALL1Seeded',
    'hltParticleFlowSuperClusterECALEndcapWithPreshower'
),
  recoEcalCandidateCollection = cms.string( "" ) )
```

### hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded

Superclusters built over the whole ECAL, with no L1 requirement. Used for the sub-leading object of double-object paths (Et > 22 GeV here), which may have no L1 seed of its own.

```
fragment.hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded = cms.EDProducer(
  "EgammaHLTRecoEcalCandidateProducers",
  scHybridBarrelProducer = cms.InputTag(
    'hltParticleFlowSuperClusterECALUnseeded',
    'hltParticleFlowSuperClusterECALBarrel' ),
  scIslandEndcapProducer = cms.InputTag(
    'hltParticleFlowSuperClusterECALUnseeded',
    'hltParticleFlowSuperClusterECALEndcapWithPreshower'
),
  recoEcalCandidateCollection = cms.string( "" ) )
```

Two producers, two RecoEcalCandidate collections, two distinct trigger objects in the event even when they describe the same photon. The trigger summary, PAT and MiniAOD keep the collection name with each object. NanoAOD decides per object type which collection names it accepts, and that decision is where the photon table goes wrong.

# HLT_Diphoton30_22_R9Id_OR_IsoCaloId_AND_HE_R9Id_Mass90: one path, two legs, four last filters

**SEEDED LEG · hltEgammaCandidates · L1-seeded · Et > 30 GeV**

L1 match, then Et > 30 GeV → R9 > 0.5 (EB) / 0.8 (EE), then H/E → either R9 > 0.85 / 0.90, last filter: **bit 14**; or cluster shape + ECAL iso, last filter: **bit 15** → leg combiner: (R9 or iso) and H/E

**UNSEEDED LEG · hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded · no L1 seed · Et > 22 GeV**

HLT1Photon: Et > 22 GeV, |eta| < 2.55, saved as type 92 → R9 > 0.5 (EB) / 0.8 (EE), then H/E → either R9 > 0.85 / 0.90, last filter: **bit 17 never set**; or cluster shape + ECAL + track iso, last filter: **bit 16 never set** → (no combiner; the ignore() filters feed the pair filter directly)

↓ Pair filter hltDiEG22R9Id85b90eORIso60CaloId15b35eANDHE12R9Id50b80eMass90CombMassLastFilter (HLTEgammaAllCombMassFilter): m(γγ) > 90 GeV, Mass95 path: > 95 GeV. No NanoAOD bit.

Bit numbers are those of NanoAOD v15 and master; in v12 to v14 the same four last filters are bits 12, 13 (seeded) and 15, 14 (unseeded). Mass95 shares the whole sequence.

# The path and its sequence as defined in the NanoAOD v13 release menu

```
# CMSSW_13_3_1_patch1, HLTrigger/Configuration/python/HLT_FULL_cff.py, line 119468 (path) and 118801 (sequence)
fragment.HLT_Diphoton30_22_R9Id_OR_IsoCaloId_AND_HE_R9Id_Mass90_v19 = cms.Path(
    fragment.HLTBeginSequence + fragment.hltL1sSingleAndDoubleEGor
  + fragment.hltPreDiphoton3022R9IdORIsoCaloIdANDHER9IdMass90
  + fragment.HLTDiphoton30L22R9Id85b90eORIso60CaloId15b35eANDHE12R9Id50b80eSequence
  + fragment.hltDiEG22R9Id85b90eORIso60CaloId15b35eANDHE12R9Id50b80eMass90CombMassLastFilter
  + fragment.HLTEndSequence )
```

```
# the sequence, e/gamma modules only; cms.ignore(f) = f is run and saves its objects but cannot stop the path
hltEgammaCandidates > hltEGL1SingleAndDoubleEGOrFilter > hltEG30L1SingleAndDoubleEGOrEtFilter
  > hltEG30LR9Id50b80eR9IdFilter > hltEG30LHE12R9Id50b80eHEFilter
  > ignore(hltEG30LR9Id85b90eHE12R9Id50b80eR9IdLastFilter)            # bit 14
  > ignore(hltEG30LCaloId15b35eHE12R9Id50b80eClusterShapeFilter)
  > ignore(hltEG30LIso60CaloId15b35eHE12R9Id50b80eEcalIsoLastFilter)        # bit 15
  > hltEG30LRId85ORIso60CaloId15b35eANDHE12R9Id50b80eLegCombLastFilter
hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded > hltDiEG22EtEta2p55UnseededFilter
  > hltDiEG22R9Id50b80eR9IdUnseededFilter > hltDiEG22HE12R9Id50b80eHEUnseededFilter
  > ignore(hltEG22R9Id85b90eHE12R9Id50b80eR9UnseededLastFilter)           # bit 17
  > ignore(hltEG22CaloId15b35eHE12R9Id50b80eClusterShapeUnseededFilter)
  > ignore(hltEG22Iso60CaloId15b35eHE12R9Id50b80eEcalIsoUnseededFilter)
  > ignore(hltEG22Iso60CaloId15b35eHE12R9Id50b80eTrackIsoUnseededLastFilter)  # bit 16
```

The producers that compute the variables (hltEgammaR9IDUnseeded, hltEgammaHoverEUnseeded, hltEgammaHollowTrackIsoUnseeded, ...) sit between the filters and are omitted here. The same sequence, module for module, is in the 2018, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025 and 2026 menus.

# The two unseeded last filters: their candidate collection is explicit in l1EGCand

```
# bit 17 (v12 to v14: bit 15), trimmed to the relevant
parameters
fragment.hltEG22R9Id85b90eHE12R9Id50b80e
  R9UnseededLastFilter = cms.EDFilter(
  "HLTEgammaGenericFilter",
  saveTags = cms.bool( True ),
  candTag = cms.InputTag(
    "hltDiEG22HE12R9Id50b80eHEUnseededFilter" ),
  varTag = cms.InputTag(
    'hltEgammaR9IDUnseeded', 'r95x5' ),
  lessThan = cms.bool( False ),
  useEt = cms.bool( False ),
  thrRegularEB = cms.vdouble( 0.85 ),
  thrRegularEE = cms.vdouble( 0.9 ),
  ncandcut = cms.int32( 1 ),
  l1EGCand = cms.InputTag(
    "hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded" ) )
```

```
# bit 16 (v12 to v14: bit 14), trimmed to the relevant
parameters
fragment.hltEG22Iso60CaloId15b35eHE12R9Id50b80e
  TrackIsoUnseededLastFilter = cms.EDFilter(
  "HLTEgammaGenericQuadraticFilter",
  saveTags = cms.bool( True ),
  candTag = cms.InputTag( "hltEG22Iso60CaloId15b35e
    HE12R9Id50b80eEcalIsoUnseededFilter" ),
  varTag = cms.InputTag(
    "hltEgammaHollowTrackIsoUnseeded" ),
  lessThan = cms.bool( True ),
  useEt = cms.bool( True ),
  thrRegularEB = cms.vdouble( 6.0 ),
  thrRegularEE = cms.vdouble( 6.0 ),
  thrOverEEB = cms.vdouble( 0.002 ),
  thrOverEEE = cms.vdouble( 0.002 ),
  ncandcut = cms.int32( 1 ),
  l1EGCand = cms.InputTag(
    "hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded" ) )
```

candTag points to the previous filter of the chain (the objects to test), varTag to the variable producer, and l1EGCand to the candidate collection the filter tags its saved objects with. The seeded last filters are identical in structure with l1EGCand = hltEgammaCandidates. Module names are broken over two lines here only for display.

# Why the unseeded objects carry type 92: the first filter of the leg saves them as TriggerCluster

```
# menu: the first unseeded filter
fragment.hltDiEG22EtEta2p55UnseededFilter =
  cms.EDFilter( "HLT1Photon",
  saveTags = cms.bool( True ),
  inputTag = cms.InputTag(
    "hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded" ),
  triggerType = cms.int32( 92 ),
  MinE = cms.double( -1.0 ),
  MinPt = cms.double( 22.0 ),
  MinMass = cms.double( -1.0 ),
  MaxMass = cms.double( -1.0 ),
  MinEta = cms.double( -1.0 ),
  MaxEta = cms.double( 2.55 ),
  MinN = cms.int32( 2 ) )
```

```
// HLTrigger/HLTfilters/plugins/HLTSinglet.cc
template <typename T>
int getObjectType(const T&) { return 0; }
// no specialisation for RecoEcalCandidate

if (saveTags())
  filterproduct.addCollectionTag(inputTag_);
...
int tid = getObjectType<T>(*i);
if (tid == 0)
  tid = triggerType_;  // 92, TriggerCluster
filterproduct.addObject(tid, ref);
```

**Result.** Every candidate of hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded with Et > 22 GeV is saved with type 92 and the collection tag hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded. On the seeded leg, HLTEgammaL1TMatchFilterRegional and HLTEgammaEtFilter save TriggerCluster as well.

**Why it matters.** The NanoAOD selection starts with type(92). It is satisfied for both legs, so the object type is not what rejects the unseeded objects; the next slide shows what the later filters save, and the slide after that where the types are merged.

# What the later filters save: HLTGenericFilter tags the collection and uses type 81 when saveTags is on

```
// HLTrigger/Egamma/plugins/HLTGenericFilter.cc (master lines 28 to 32 and 139 to 159; same logic from 10_6_X on)
l1EGTag_ = iConfig.template getParameter<edm::InputTag>("l1EGCand");
...
if (saveTags()) {
  filterproduct.addCollectionTag(l1EGTag_);  // hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded for the unseeded leg
}
// Set output format
int trigger_type = trigger::TriggerCluster;
if (saveTags())
  trigger_type = trigger::TriggerPhoton;          // 81 for every saved object
...
PrevFilterOutput→getObjects(TriggerCluster, recoCands);
if (recoCands.empty())
  PrevFilterOutput→getObjects(TriggerPhoton, recoCands);  // accepts either type from the previous filter
```

**Collection.** The saved reference points into the l1EGCand collection. For the unseeded last filters that is hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded, which PAT turns into the label hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded::HLT on the object.

**Type.** These filters save type 81 (TriggerPhoton). The object keeps the 92 it received from the first filter, because PAT attaches the type of every filter that accepted an object (next slide). So type(92) in NanoAOD passes, and the collection test is the only thing left to fail.

**Unchanged for years.** The same three statements are in the 10_6_X, 12_4_X, 12_6_X, 13_0_X, 13_3_X, 14_0_X, 15_0_X and master versions of the plugin (only the line numbers move).

# The trigger summary and PAT keep everything: collection label, all types, all filter labels

```
# menu: the summary producer
fragment.hltTriggerSummaryAOD =
  cms.EDProducer(
  "TriggerSummaryProducerAOD",
  throw = cms.bool( False ),
  processName = cms.string( "@" ),
  moduleLabelPatternsToMatch =
    cms.vstring( 'hlt*' ),
  moduleLabelPatternsToSkip =
    cms.vstring( ) )
```

Every filter with saveTags contributes; objects are stored once per collection tag, and each filter records the keys of its objects and the type it saved them with.

```
// PhysicsTools/PatAlgos/plugins/PATTriggerProducer.cc (master 680
to 731)
for (size_t iK = 0; iK < keys.size(); ++iK) {
  filterLabels.insert({keys[iK], nameFilter});
  objectTypes.insert({keys[iK], types[iK]});  // per filter
}
...
triggerObject.setCollection(
    handleTriggerEvent→collectionTagEncoded(iC));
for (auto t = objectTypes.equal_range(iO); ...)
  triggerObject.addTriggerObjectType(t.first→second);
...
triggerObjectStandAlone.addFilterLabel(frange.first→second);
triggerObjectStandAlone.addPathName(iP→pathName, ...);
```

**Collection.** setCollection stores the encoded tag of the collection the object came from: hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded::HLT for the sub-leading leg, hltEgammaCandidates::HLT for the leading one.

**Types and labels.** addTriggerObjectType is called for every filter that referenced the object, so the unseeded object carries 92 and 81; addFilterLabel records every filter label, including the two unseeded last filters NanoAOD looks for.

# MiniAOD slims the objects but keeps the collection name; NanoAOD unpacks the labels again

```
#
PatAlgos/python/slimming/selectedPatTrigger_cfi.py
selectedPatTrigger = cms.EDFilter(
  "PATTriggerObjectStandAloneSelector",
  src = cms.InputTag("patTrigger"),
  cut = cms.string("!filterLabels.empty()")
)
```

Keeps every object accepted by at least one filter with saveTags. The unseeded photons carry their last-filter labels, so they stay.

```
#
PatAlgos/python/slimming/slimmedPatTrigger_cfi.py
slimmedPatTrigger = cms.EDProducer(
  "PATTriggerObjectStandAloneSlimmer",
  src = cms.InputTag("selectedPatTrigger"),
  triggerResults =
    cms.InputTag( 'TriggerResults::HLT' ),
  packFilterLabels = cms.bool(True),
  packP4 = cms.bool(True),
)
```

Packs the four-vector and the filter labels; the collection string and the type list are stored as they are.

```
# NanoAOD/python/triggerObjects_cff.py,
lines 8 to 12
unpackedPatTrigger = cms.EDProducer(
  "PATTriggerObjectStandAloneUnpacker",
  patTriggerObjectsStandAlone =
    cms.InputTag('slimmedPatTrigger'),
  triggerResults =
    cms.InputTag('TriggerResults::HLT'),
  unpackFilterLabels = cms.bool(True)
)
```

Restores the labels so that filter('...') can be evaluated; hasFilterOrCondition throws if labels are still packed.

Proof that the unseeded objects really reach NanoAOD: the Electron selection has accepted coll('hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded') since June 2023 and its bit "2e (CaloIdL_MW unseeded)" is populated in production files. The same objects enter the Photon branch of the producer and are rejected there.

# The NanoAOD Photon selection: one collection in sel, three unseeded filters in the bit list

```
# PhysicsTools/NanoAOD/python/triggerObjects_cff.py, master lines 88 to 116 (v13: 81 to 108), abbreviated
Photon = cms.PSet(
  id = cms.int32(22),
  sel = cms.string("type(92) && pt > 15 && coll('hltEgammaCandidates')"),
  l1seed = cms.string("type(-98)"),  l1deltaR = cms.double(0.3),
  skipObjectsNotPassingQualityBits = cms.bool(True),
  qualityBits = cms.VPSet(
    mksel("filter('hltEG33L1EG26HEFilter')","hltEG33L1EG26HEFilter"),                  # bit 0
    ...  # bits 1 to 13: HE filters, hltHtEcal800, EB tight-ID filters, Mu17_Photon30 photon leg
    mksel("filter('hltEG30LR9Id85b90eHE12R9Id50b80eR9IdLastFilter')", ...),              # 14
    mksel("filter('hltEG30LIso60CaloId15b35eHE12R9Id50b80eEcalIsoLastFilter')", ...),    # 15
    mksel("filter('hltEG22Iso60CaloId15b35eHE12R9Id50b80eTrackIsoUnseededLastFilter')", ...),  # 16
    mksel("filter('hltEG22R9Id85b90eHE12R9Id50b80eR9UnseededLastFilter')", ...),             # 17
    mksel("filter('hltEG30Iso60CaloId15b35eR9Id50b90eHE12b10eR9Id50b80eEcalIsoFilter')", ...),  # 18
    mksel("filter('hltEG18TrackIso60Iso60CaloId15b35eR9Id50b90eHE12b10eR9Id50b80e
           TrackIsoUnseededFilter')", ...),                                            # 19
    mksel("filter('hltEG*L1VBFLooseIsoEGHEFilter')", "hltEG*L1VBFLooseIsoEGHEFilter"),             # 20
  )
),
```

**mksel** turns a filter name into filter('name'), a list into an OR (max of the terms) and a tuple into an AND; bit i is the position in the VPSet unless bit= is given. No photon entry uses an explicit bit.

**The contradiction** is inside this one PSet: sel admits only hltEgammaCandidates, while bits 16, 17 and 19 name filters that run exclusively on hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded (slide 7). No era modifier touches this block.

# The table producer: sel first, bits second, duplicates merged last

```
// TriggerObjectTableProducer.cc, constructor,
// lines 105 to 118; cfg = qualityBitsConfig
for (size_t i = 0; i =/= cfg.size(); ++i) {
  unsigned int bit = i;
  if (cfg[i].existsAs<unsigned int>("bit"))
    bit = cfg[i].getParameter<unsigned int>("bit");
  assert(!bits[bit] && "...inserted twice");
  assert(bit < 64 && "...on 64 bits");
  func << std::to_string(1UL << bit) << "*("
       << cfg[i].getParameter<std::string>(
            "selection") << ")";
}
qualityBits = StringObjectFunction<...>(func.str());
```

The bits form one string function, the sum of 2^bit times each entry's selection. It is evaluated only for objects that already passed sel.

```
// produce(), master lines 151 to 176
for (const auto &obj : trigObjs) {
  for (const auto &sel : sels_) {
    if (sel.match(obj)) {  // fails here
      bits = sel.qualityBits(obj);
      if (skip ? (bits =/= 0) : true)
        selected.emplace_back(&obj, &sel);
    }
  }
}
// Self-cleaning
for (i ...) for (j < i ...)
  if (sel.id == sel2.id
      && deltaR2(obj, obj2) < 1e-6) {
    bits_of(obj2) |= bits_of(obj);
    selected.erase(selected.begin() + i); i--;
  }
```

Abridged: bits stands for selected_bits[sel.id][&obj], skip for sel.skipObjectsNotPassingQualityBits.

**Order of evaluation is the whole story.** An object that fails sel never reaches qualityBits, never enters selected, and is never seen by the merging loop. No later step can restore it.

**No break.** Since 13_0_X an object is tested against every selection and can be written once per type it passes (an e/gamma object can be both id 11 and id 22). 12_4_X still had a break after the first match.

# The producer changed three times since 2022; the selection-before-bits order never did

| releases (NanoAOD) | filterBits type | bit limit | duplicate merging | selections per object |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 12_4_X, 12_6_X (v10, v11) | Int_t | bit < 31 | same id, same pT, same direction | first match only (break) |
| 13_0_X to 14_2_X, 15_0_0, 15_0_1 (v12, v13, v14) | Int_t | bit < 31 | same id, \|delta pT\| < 1e-6, delta R squared < 1e-6 (pT test dropped in 15_0_0) | every matching selection |
| 15_0_2 onward, master (v15, next) | unsigned 64-bit | bit < 64 | same id, delta R squared < 1e-6 | every matching selection |

```
// CMSSW_13_3_1_patch1 (v13), lines 114, 154, 170
assert(bit < 31 && "quality bits are store on 32
bit");
selected_bits[sel.id][&obj] =
int(sel.qualityBits(obj));
if (sel.id == sel2.id
    && abs(obj.pt() - obj2.pt()) < 1e-6
    && deltaR2(obj, obj2) < 1e-6) {
```

```
// master and CMSSW_15_0_2, lines 114, 154, 170
assert(bit < 64 && "quality bits are store on 64
bits");
selected_bits[sel.id][&obj] = sel.qualityBits(obj);
if (sel.id == sel2.id
    && deltaR2(obj, obj2) < 1e-6) {
```

What matters for this issue is in every version: sel.match(obj) is tested first, and only a passing object gets its quality bits computed. The merging rule only decides what happens after the fix, when a seeded and an unseeded object describe the same photon: with the master rule they merge on direction alone.

# How coll('hltEgammaCandidates') is evaluated: no star, so an exact label comparison

```
// DataFormats/PatCandidates/src/TriggerObjectStandAlone.cc
bool TriggerObjectStandAlone::hasCollection(
    const std::string &collName) const {
  // Move to wild-card parser, if needed only
  if (collName.find(wildcard_) != std::string::npos) {
    if (hasAnyName(collName, {collection()}))
      return true;
    ...   // label / instance / process with wildcards
    return false;
  }
  // Use parent class's method otherwise
  return TriggerObject::hasCollection(collName);
}
```

```
// DataFormats/PatCandidates/src/TriggerObject.cc, 54 to 71
bool TriggerObject::hasCollection(
    const std::string& collName) const {
  if (collName == collection_) return true;
  const edm::InputTag collectionTag(collection_);
  const edm::InputTag collTag(collName);
  if (collTag.process().empty()) {
    if ((collTag.instance().empty()
        && collectionTag.instance().empty())
        || collTag.instance() == collectionTag.instance())
{
      return (collTag.label() == collectionTag.label());
    }
  }
  return false;
}
```

**Evaluated for the unseeded object:** collName = hltEgammaCandidates, collection_ = hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded::HLT. No star, so the base method runs; labels hltEgammaCandidates and hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded differ; the result is false.

**Wildcards do exist** (the Run 2 muon selection writes coll('hlt*L3MuonCandidates')), so coll('hltEgammaCandidates*') would also have worked. The explicit OR of the two names was chosen for the fix because it names exactly the two collections.

# One unseeded photon object through the Photon selection, test by test

**1** **type(92)**: true. hltDiEG22EtEta2p55UnseededFilter saved the object with triggerType 92 and PAT kept that type next to the 81 of the later filters.

**2** **pt > 15**: true. MinPt is 22 GeV on this leg (18 GeV for the Diphoton30_18 paths).

**3** **coll('hltEgammaCandidates')**: false. The label is hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded; exact comparison (previous slide).

**4** **sel.match(obj) is false**: qualityBits is never evaluated; the object is not in selected; bits 16 and 17 are 0 in every event, in every file.

```
# the Electron selection, same file
# CMSSW_13_0_13 (v12)
sel = "type(92) && pt > 7
  && coll('hltEgammaCandidates')
  && filter('*PixelMatchFilter')"

# CMSSW_13_3_0 onward (v13), PR 41827
sel = "type(92) && pt > 7
  && (coll('hltEgammaCandidates')
      || coll('hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded'))
  && (filter('*PixelMatchFilter')
      || filter('*PixelMatchUnseededFilter'))"
```

PR 41827 (merged 8 June 2023) added the unseeded CaloIdL_MW electron bit and "added the collection hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded, which are the objects on which the selection of the unseeded trigger leg is made". The photon diphoton bits had been added four months earlier by PR 40711 without that change, and nobody came back to it.

# Six other explanations, and the evidence that rules each one out

| hypothesis | what the code and the menus show | verdict |
|---|---|---|
| The filter names in NanoAOD are misspelt or outdated | All four Diphoton30_22 names are defined with saveTags = True in the 2018 GRun, 2022 v1.2/v1.4/v1.5, 2023, 2024, 2025 and 2026 menus and in every development menu checked (19 files); the chain is identical everywhere | ruled out |
| The unseeded objects never reach MiniAOD | patTrigger excludes no collection; selectedPatTrigger keeps objects with any filter label; the Electron selection has consumed coll('hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded') in production since June 2023 | ruled out |
| The objects have the wrong type for type(92) | HLT1Photon saves them with triggerType 92; the later filters add 81; PAT keeps both types | ruled out |
| The pT threshold removes them | sel requires pt > 15; the unseeded leg requires Et > 22 GeV (18 GeV for Diphoton30_18) | ruled out |
| An era modifier changes the Photon block for Run 3 | The modifiers in triggerObjects_cff.py act on Muon, Tau and Jet (Run 2 eras) and on the prefiring producer; none touches Photon | ruled out |
| Something specific to the v13 release | CMSSW_13_3_1_patch1 and the 13_3_X tip have byte-identical NanoAOD configuration; 13_0_X, 14_0_X, 15_0_X, 16_x and master carry the same Photon selection | ruled out |
| The Photon selection rejects the collection | sel = type(92) && pt > 15 && coll('hltEgammaCandidates'), exact comparison, evaluated before the bits | the cause |

Each row was checked in the source: menu files (filter definitions and saveTags), PhysicsTools/PatAlgos (patTrigger, selectedPatTrigger, slimmedPatTrigger), the HLT plugins (HLTSinglet, HLTGenericFilter), the era modifiers at the end of triggerObjects_cff.py, and the configuration at the tags and branch tips named on the next slide.

# Scope by NanoAOD version: present since the bits were added, still present in today's master

| NanoAOD | releases checked (tags and branch tips) | Photon sel | Electron sel | dead photon bits | affected |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| v9 | CMSSW_10_6_X | seeded, pt > 20, no bits | seeded | no photon TrigObj | no |
| v10, v11 | CMSSW_12_4_X, CMSSW_12_6_X | seeded, pt > 20, 12 bits | seeded | bits absent | no |
| v12 | 13_0_0 (pt > 20), 13_0_1 to 13_0_17 (prod. 13_0_13) | seeded, 18 bits | seeded | 14, 15, 17 | yes |
| v13 | 13_3_0, 13_3_1_patch1 (production), 13_3_X tip | seeded, 18 bits | seeded + unseeded | 14, 15, 17 | yes |
| v14 | 14_0_0, 14_0_X tip, 14_1_0, 14_1_X, 14_2_0, 14_2_X | seeded, 18 bits | seeded + unseeded | 14, 15, 17 | yes |
| v15 | 15_0_2 to 15_0_15_patch4, 15_0_X tip, 15_1_0, 15_1_X (15_0_0 and 15_0_1 still 18 bits) | seeded, 21 bits | seeded + unseeded | 16, 17, 19 | yes |
| next | 16_0_10, 16_0_X, 16_1_3, 16_1_X, master ed35654b1 (4 Nov 2026, newest commit) | seeded, 21 bits | seeded + unseeded | 16, 17, 19 | yes |

**Checked live today.** git ls-remote on cms-sw/cmssw gives master = ed35654b1 (no newer commit), 16_1_X = 8aacfa5da, 16_0_X = de8bdeed9, 15_1_X = e9272496, 15_0_X = 6db81eb6d; the Photon selection line is identical on all of them and at the newest tags CMSSW_16_1_3 and CMSSW_16_0_10.

**Nobody has fixed it elsewhere.** GitHub shows no open pull request or issue mentioning hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded, triggerObjects_cff or photon trigger objects, and no change to triggerObjects_cff.py since June 2026.

# Confirmed on thirteen NanoAOD files, v9 to v15 and 2026 data: the unseeded photon bits are never set

| NanoAOD | file (one per dataset, read on lxplus) | events | fired Mass90 | photons: seeded bits | unseeded bits | e unseeded | id 2 | id 1515 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| v9 | UL2018 data, EGamma 2018D | 300000 | 31771 | no photon TrigObj | none defined | n/a | 0 | 0 |
| v10 | 2022 prompt data, EGamma 2022D | 300000 | 46707 | bits not defined | none defined | n/a | 0 | 0 |
| v11 | 2022 prompt data, EGamma 2022F | 300000 | 41546 | bits not defined | none defined | n/a | 0 | 0 |
| v12 | Summer22 MC, GluGluHtoGG M125 | 12979 | 7725 | 15626 / 17978 | 0 / 0 / 0 | n/a | 0 | 0 |
| v12 | 2022 data, EGamma 2022D 22Sep2023 | 300000 | 46407 | 208527 / 255099 | 0 / 0 / 0 | n/a | 0 | 0 |
| v13 | Summer23 MC, GluGluHto2G M125 | 17760 | 10453 | 20865 / 24170 | 0 / 0 / 0 | 702 | 0 | 0 |
| v13 | 2022 data, EGamma 2022D 16Dec2023 | 300000 | 46794 | 207844 / 252774 | 0 / 0 / 0 | 29042 | 0 | 0 |
| v14 | 2024 prompt data, EGamma0 2024D | 300000 | 35892 | 203620 / 252039 | 0 / 0 / 0 | 19444 | 0 | 0 |
| v15 | Summer24 MC, GluGluH to 2G M125 | 4180 | 2406 | 4815 / 5588 | 0 / 0 / 0 | 205 | 0 | 22 |
| v15 | 2022 data, EGamma 2022D NanoAODv15 | 300000 | 48687 | 212270 / 258546 | 0 / 0 / 0 | 30451 | 0 | 430 |
| v15 | 2024 data, EGamma0 2024D MINIv6NANOv15 | 300000 | 30945 | 201628 / 248974 | 0 / 0 / 0 | 22980 | 0 | 254 |
| 133X | Winter24 MC, GluGluHToGG M125 powheg | 175654 | 101598 | 205090 / 239250 | 0 / 0 / 0 | 9860 | 0 | 0 |
| 16_0_X | 2026 data, EGamma0 2026C PromptReco | 300000 | 1511 | 124972 / 145161 | 0 / 0 / 0 | 1034 | 0 | 42 |

**Controls behave.** v9 has no photon objects; v10 and v11 document no diphoton bits; the electron unseeded bit is absent in v12 and populated from v13.

**Affected versions behave.** Seeded bits on more objects than Mass90 events; unseeded bits 0 in all 2.0 million events of v12 to v15, Winter24 (133X) and 2026 data (16_0_X).

**Side findings behave.**
No id 2 (MET) object in any file; id 1515 (BoostedTau) only in v15 (22, 430, 254). Fix re-run: next slide.

# Fix test on real input: every Mass90 event gets its sub-leading-leg bits, nothing else changes

| NANO file (v13, v15: 17760 events; 16_0_X: 20000) | fired Mass90 | photons: seeded bits | photons: unseeded bits | Mass90 events with an unseeded bit | nTrigObj mean | size (bytes) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| central v13 file | 10453 | 20865 / 24170 | 0 / 0 / 0 | 0 | 5.287 | 29333713 |
| v13 re-made, no fix | 10453 | 20865 / 24170 | 0 / 0 / 0 | 0 | 5.287 | 29339920 |
| v13 re-made, with fix | 10453 | 20865 / 24170 | 20461 / 18365 / 0 | 10453 (all) | 5.388 | 29363499 |
| v15 re-made, no fix | 10453 | 20865 / 24170 | 0 / 0 / 0 | 0 | 38.134 | 39947152 |
| v15 re-made, with fix | 10453 | 20865 / 24170 | 20461 / 18365 / 0 | 10453 (all) | 38.225 | 39959608 |
| 16_0_X 2026C data, no fix | 308 | 8909 / 10760 | 0 / 0 / 0 | 0 | 2.100 | 26190407 |
| 16_0_X 2026C data, with fix | 308 | 8909 / 10760 | 671 / 1010 / 0 | 308 (all) | 2.118 | 26206694 |

- Re-made without the fix, the file is identical to the central v13 file: same TrigObj (id, bits, pt) in 17760 of 17760 events.
- The 21254 photon objects that gain an unseeded bit have pt from 22.04 GeV (median 58.30 GeV), none below the 22 GeV leg threshold.
- Every object type other than photons is unchanged in 17760 of 17760 events; photon objects 24835 to 26639 (v13), 25188 to 26807 (v15).
- The third unseeded bit (Diphoton30_18 leg) stays 0: that filter name does not exist in the 2023 menu; also 0 in 2026 data (not investigated).
- 2026 data, CMSSW_16_0_4_patch2, 20000 events of a Run2026C MINIAOD file: unseeded bits in all 308 Mass90 events, none before; pt from 22.01 GeV (median 37.06 GeV). Not compared event by event with a central file.
- Relval in CMSSW_16_1_3 with the fix (12452.0, 141.046): builds and runs without exceptions; outputs identical to the clean release except 25 DQM TimerService histograms per workflow. Its NANO TrigObj table is empty in both areas, so it does not exercise the photon selection.

Seeded / unseeded bits: 12, 13 / 14, 15, 17 in v13; 14, 15 / 16, 17, 19 in v15. Input: the MiniAOD parent of the central Run3Summer23 v13 GluGluHto2G M125 file; CMSSW_13_3_1_patch1 (v13) and CMSSW_15_0_15_patch4 (v15). 5 November 2026, results/REPORT.md "Fix test" and "Relval in CMSSW_16_1_3".

# Scope by HLT menu: nine years of menus, the same four filters on the same collections

| menu (table name) | Mass90/95 | Diphoton30_18 | unseeded photon bits dead (v12 to v14 / v15 numbering) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 2018 GRun, /dev/CMSSW_10_6_0/GRun/V3 | v13 | NoPixelVeto v2 | 14, 15, 17 / 16, 17, 19 |
| 2022 frozen v1.2 (HLT_2022v12, Run3Summer22 MC) | v13 | v2 | 14, 15, 17 / 16, 17, 19 |
| 2022 frozen v1.4 and v1.5, GRun 12_4 V171, GRun 12_6 V16 | v15 | v3 | 14, 15, 17 / 16, 17, 19 |
| 2023 frozen v1.2 (HLT_2023v12), GRun 13_0 V153 | v17 | v5 (renamed filters) | 14, 15 / 16, 17 |
| 2023 development, 13_3 GRun V11 and HLT V19 | v19 | v7 | 14, 15 / 16, 17 |
| 2024 frozen v1.4 (HLT_2024v14), GRun 14_0 V182 | v22 | v10 | 14, 15 / 16, 17 |
| 2025 development (fork, May 2025), GRun 15_0 V62 | v24 | v12 | 16, 17 |
| 2025 frozen v1.3 (HLT_2025v13), GRun 15_0 V120 | v26 | v14 | 16, 17 |
| 2026 frozen v1.3 (HLT_2026v13, in master) | v29 | v17 | 16, 17 |
| 2026 development, GRun 16_1 V16 (master) | v30 | v18 | 16, 17 |

In all of these the two unseeded last filters of the Mass90/Mass95 sequence carry l1EGCand = hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded and saveTags = True, and the ordered list of the sixteen e/gamma filters of the sequence is identical (same MD5). From 2023 the Diphoton30_18 filters were renamed, so its two NanoAOD bits (18, 19) match nothing in those menus, a separate stale-name problem.

# How widespread: a scanner that resolves every filter bit of every object type against each menu

```
# scripts/deadbits.py (notes repository), the core
def glob_re(pat):  # NanoAOD wildcard semantics
  parts = pat.split("*")
  return re.compile("^" + ".*".join(
      re.escape(p) for p in parts) + "$")

def collections_of(mods, name):
  # EDProducer labels a filter saves its objects from
  typ, body = mods[name]
  for p in ("l1EGCand", "inputTag", "CandTag",
            "inputCandCollection", "originTag1", ...):
    for lab in tag_labels(body, p):
      if mods[lab][0] == "EDProducer": direct.add(lab)
      elif mods[lab][0] == "EDFilter": follow.append(lab)
  return direct or union(collections_of(mods, f) for f in follow)

status = OK if any matched filter's collection passes coll()
       else COLL if filters match but none passes
       else STALE if no module matches the pattern
```

**Inputs**

Configs: master, 15_0_X (v15), 13_3_1_patch1 (v13), 13_0_13 (v12). Menus: frozen 2022 v1.2 and v1.4, 2023 v1.2, 2024 v1.4, 2025 v1.3, 2026 v1.3, plus the GRun development menus of 13_0_X, 14_0_X, 15_0_X and 16_1_X.

**What it emulates**

mksel (lists are ORs, tuples ANDs), the anchored star matching of hasAnyName, the collection each matched filter saves (following inputTag chains for combination filters), and the coll() terms of each selection. The type test is not emulated; the Tau selection's coll('*Tau*') is OR-ed with filters and treated as non-restrictive.

**Outputs**

Per config, selection, bit and menu: OK, COLL, STALE or UNK (L1-seed modules, accepted by type). Raw outputs are in scan/ of the notes repository.

# Scan results: the collection mismatch is unique to the Photon list; stale names are everywhere

| object | bits | never settable (collection or type) | fine / stale, 2024 menu | fine / stale, 2025 menu | stale in 2025, why |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Electron | 20 | none | 19 / 1 | 18 / 2 | WPLoose (gone 2023), triple-electron (gone 2025) |
| Photon | 21 | bits 16, 17, 19 (unseeded) and 8 (hltHtEcal800) | 15 / 3 | 15 / 3 | bit 12 (gone 2022), 18 and 19 (renamed 2023) |
| Muon | 14 | none | 14 / 0 | 12 / 2 | mu-tau DeepTau overlaps (gone 2025) |
| Tau | 31 | none | 31 / 0 | 30 / 1 | DeepTau (gone 2025) |
| BoostedTau | 3 | v12 to v14: the whole selection (next slide) | 2 / 1 | 2 / 1 | 2022 ParticleNetTauTau name |
| Jet | 46 | none | 37 (+2 L1) / 7 | 34 (+2 L1) / 10 | pixel-only HH4b filters (gone 2024), DeepCSV and DeepJet (gone 2025), 3-jet pt40 and pt45 |
| FatJet | 7 | none | 4 / 3 | 4 / 3 | 2022 and 2023 soft-drop and ParticleNet names |
| HT, MHT | 6, 2 | none | 3 (+1 L1) / 2, 2 / 0 | same | two Run 2 L1 seed names, never in Run 3 menus |
| MET | 0 | no bits with the skip flag on: never written | none | none | all versions since v9 |

**Same mechanism as the diphoton bits:** only Photon bit 8, whose filter saves HT objects. Electron and Muon have no collection mismatch in any version or menu.

**Stale names are a documentation problem:** one bit list serves the 2022 to 2026 menus, so bits for renamed or retired filters stay documented but silently empty for later years.

# Three more entries that can never be filled, found by the same scan

### Photon bit 8: hltHtEcal800

```
fragment.hltHtEcal800 =
cms.EDFilter(
  "HLTHtMhtFilter",
  saveTags = cms.bool( True ),
  htLabels = cms.VInputTag(
    'hltHtMhtEcal' ),
  minHt = cms.vdouble( 800.0 ),
... )

// HLTHtMhtFilter.cc, 104 to 105
addObject(trigger::TriggerTHT,
htref);
addObject(trigger::TriggerMHT,
mhtref);
```

HT objects (types 89, 90) from hltHtMhtEcal: never type 92, never an e/gamma collection. Dead since the bit appeared in the 12_4_X list (v10); the v9 photon list had no bits at all.

### MET: no bits, skip flag on

```
MET = cms.PSet(
  id = cms.int32(2),
  sel = cms.string("type(87) && pt
> 30
    && coll('hltPFMETProducer')"),
  skipObjectsNotPassingQualityBits
    = cms.bool(True),
  qualityBits = cms.VPSet()
)
```

With no entries the bit function is the constant "0"; with the skip flag every MET object is dropped. Identical in 10_6_X (qualityBits "0"), 12_4_X, v12 to v15 and master: TrigObj has never contained MET entries although the documentation lists id 2.

### BoostedTau in v12 to v14: empty table

```
# 13_0_X to 15_0_1
sel = "type(85) && pt > 120
  && coll('hltAK8PFJetsCorrected')
  && filter('hltAK8SinglePFJets*
     SoftDropMass40*ParticleNetTauTau')"

# menus: 2022 ...ParticleNetTauTau0p30
#        2023+ ...PNetTauTauTag0p03
# 15_0_2: filter('*TauTau*')
```

The pattern is anchored at its end, so no menu name ever matched, and the jets come from hltAK8PFJets230SoftDropMass40, not hltAK8PFJetsCorrected. Relaxed in CMSSW_15_0_2.

# Stale bits by year: documented filters that no longer exist in the menu of that year

| object | bit | filter pattern (master list) | exists in menus | empty for data of |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Electron | 2 | hltEle*WPLoose*TrackIsoFilter | 2022 | 2023 onward |
| Electron | 8 | hltEle*Ele*Ele*CaloIdLTrackIdLDphiLeg*Filter (3e) | 2022 to 2024 | 2025 onward |
| Photon | 12 | hltEG120EBTightIDTightIsoTrackIsoFilter | 2018, early 2022 | 2022 v1.4 onward |
| Photon | 18, 19 | hltEG30Iso60CaloId15b35eR9Id50b90eHE12b10e… and hltEG18TrackIso60… (Diphoton30_18) | 2018, 2022 | 2023 onward (renamed) |
| Muon | 2, 6 | *OverlapFilterIsoMu*PFTau* (DeepTau mu-tau overlap) | 2022 to 2024 | 2025 onward (bit 13 PNet replaces) |
| Tau | 3 | *DeepTau* | 2022 to 2024 | 2025 onward (bit 4 PNet replaces) |
| BoostedTau | 0 | hltAK8SinglePFJets*SoftDropMass*ParticleNetTauTau0p30 | 2022 | 2023 onward (bits 1, 2 replace) |
| Jet | 0, 1, 6, 22, 27 | hlt{4,3,2,1}PixelOnlyPFCentralJetTightIDPt{20,30,40,60} (HH to 4b) | 2022, 2023 | 2024 onward |
| Jet | 8, 9, 11, 24, 25 | hlt3PFCentralJetTightIDPt40/45, hltBTagCaloDeepCSVp17Double, hltBTagPFDeepJet1p5Single/4p5Triple | 2022 to 2023/2024 | 2023, 2024 or 2025 onward |
| FatJet | 3, 4, 5 | …SoftDropMass40BTagParticleNetBB0p35, hltAK8DoublePFJetSDModMass30/50 | 2022 (and 2023 for 4, 5) | 2023 or 2024 onward |
| HT | 0, 1 | hltL1sTripleJetVBFIorHTTIorDoubleJetCIorSingleJet, hltL1sQuadJetC50Ior… (Run 2 L1 seeds) | Run 2 only | all Run 3 |

Bits added for newer filters (for example Photon 9, 10, 20; Electron 17, 19; Tau PNet entries; Jet 28 to 41) are empty for the earlier years in the same way. None of this is a code defect; it is the price of one bit list for five years of menus, and the documentation string does not say which years a bit covers.

# What analyses see: every Run 3 NanoAOD file, and no sub-leading match for the diphoton triggers

### Datasets

Data: 2022 (PromptNano v10/v11, 22Sep2023 v12, 16Dec2023 v13), 2023 (22Sep2023 v12), 2024 (prompt v14), 2025 (prompt v15) and the v15 re-NANO of 2022 to 2024. MC: Run3Summer22, 22EE, 23, 23BPix at v12 and v13, Summer24 at v15, and the v15 re-NANO of all of them. Any Run 2 input re-processed with v12 or later.

### Frameworks

NanoAOD-based photon matching (HiggsDNA-style workflows, the HYgammaRunIII legend that lists bits 16 and 17 as the legs, FLAF configurations, custom NanoAOD setups) finds no object for the sub-leading leg. MiniAOD-based flashgg reads the pat trigger objects directly and is unaffected.

**Existing files cannot be repaired.** The unseeded objects were never written; no post-processing can recover them. Only a new NANO pass with the fix restores the information.

```
# schematic TrigObj rows of one diphoton-triggered event
# (illustration of the structure, not real data)
today (v15):
 id  pt     filterBits      meaning
 22  41.7   0x4000 (bit 14)  leading leg, R9 last
 -- no row for the 26 GeV photon --

with the fix:
 22  41.7   0x4000 (bit 14)  leading leg, R9 last
 22  26.3   0x20000 (bit 17) unseeded leg, R9 last
```

A leading photon that also passes the unseeded leg merges with its unseeded twin (same direction) and carries both bits; a sub-leading photon appears as a new row.

# The fix: accept both e/gamma collections in the Photon selection

```
diff --git a/PhysicsTools/NanoAOD/python/triggerObjects_cff.py b/PhysicsTools/NanoAOD/python/triggerObjects_cff.py
@@ -87,7 +87,7 @@ triggerObjectTable = triggerObjectTableProducer.clone(
         Photon = cms.PSet(
             id = cms.int32(22),
-            sel = cms.string("type(92) && pt > 15 && coll('hltEgammaCandidates')"),
+            sel = cms.string("type(92) && pt > 15 && (coll('hltEgammaCandidates') ||
coll('hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded'))"),
             l1seed = cms.string("type(-98)"),  l1deltaR = cms.double(0.3),
             skipObjectsNotPassingQualityBits = cms.bool(True),
```

### Why this form

Names exactly the two collections and copies the Electron selection of PR 41827. A wildcard would also match (next slide) but would admit any future collection with that prefix.

### What changes

Unseeded objects enter the photon branch; with the skip flag only those that set a photon bit are written, and the only photon-bit filters on the unseeded collection are the three diphoton ones. A seeded twin in the same direction is merged with OR-ed bits.

### What does not

Bit numbers, documentation strings, the other object types and the event content. Only events that fired a diphoton trigger gain photon rows.

**Status.** Committed as 1699a39f7 on the fork branch claude/fervent-lamport-3oiuh6 and as aebf3eb64 on branch nano-photon-trigobj-unseeded on top of upstream master ed35654b1. Both branches are on the fork; nothing pushed to cms-sw/cmssw, no pull request opened.

# Why not a wildcard, and exactly which objects the fix lets through

```
// TriggerObjectStandAlone::hasAnyName, lines 80 to 119 (abridged)
boost::split(parts, name, is_any_of("*"), token_compress_on);
for (name in nameVec) {
  index = 0;
  for (part in parts) {
    if (part.empty()) continue;
    index = name.find(part, index);
    if (index == npos ||
        (part is first && index > 0)) { failed; break; }
    index += part.length();
  }
  // Failed, if end of name not reached
  if (index < name.length() && !parts.back().empty())
    failed = true;
}
```

coll('hltEgammaCandidates*') would match both collections. The anchoring rule is also what kills the v12 to v14 BoostedTau pattern (no trailing star, name continues).

| unseeded filter that is a photon bit | bit | menus |
|---|---|---|
| hltEG22Iso60CaloId15b35eHE12R9Id50b80e TrackIsoUnseededLastFilter | 16 | 2018 to 2026 |
| hltEG22R9Id85b90eHE12R9Id50b80e R9UnseededLastFilter | 17 | 2018 to 2026 |
| hltEG18TrackIso60Iso60CaloId15b35eR9Id50b90e HE12b10eR9Id50b80eTrackIsoUnseededFilter | 19 | 2018, 2022 |

These are the only entries of the photon list whose filters run on hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded (checked in nine menus; the wildcard bit 20 matches only the seeded hltEG22L1VBFLooseIsoEGHEFilter). Every other unseeded e/gamma object, for example from electron pixel-match legs, sets no photon bit and is dropped by the skip flag. The output grows only where these three filters fired.

# Validation: relval workflows before and after, and a direct count of the new bits

### 1. Standard workflows with a NANO step

Done in CMSSW_16_1_3 (5 November): 12452.0 (10 events) and 141.046 (100 events). No exceptions; identical to the clean release except DQM timing histograms. The relval NANO has no TrigObj, so the photon selection is not exercised.

### 2. Differences seen in the fix test

NANO re-made from one MiniAOD file (17760 events): unseeded bits in all 10453 Mass90 events (zero before), pt from 22.04 GeV; every other object type identical in all events. 2026 data, 16_0_4_patch2, 20000 events: all 308 Mass90 events (zero before), pt from 22.01 GeV.

### 3. Already measured on files

Thirteen NanoAOD files, v9 to v15 and 2026 data (4-5 November): unseeded photon bits 0 in all of them, all controls as predicted (results/REPORT.md).

```
# count photon objects with the unseeded bits, per path
import uproot, awkward as ak, numpy as np
t = uproot.open("nano.root")["Events"]
path = "HLT_Diphoton30_22_R9Id_OR_IsoCaloId_AND_HE_R9Id_Mass90"
a = t.arrays(["TrigObj_id", "TrigObj_filterBits", path])
ph    = a["TrigObj_id"] == 22
bits  = ak.values_astype(a["TrigObj_filterBits"][ph],
np.uint64)
fired = a[path]
for bit in (16, 17):   # 14, 15 for NanoAOD v12 to v14
  has = ak.any(((bits >> np.uint64(bit)) & np.uint64(1)) == 1,
               axis=1)
  print(bit, int(np.sum(has & fired)), "of",
int(np.sum(fired)))
```

Before the fix both counts are 0 by construction. After it they must be of the order of the number of events that fired the path. Measured in the fix test: every one of the 10453 Mass90 events has a photon with at least one of the two bits.

# Pull request plan, current status and the follow-ups kept out of the one-line fix

```
# pull request (prepared, not opened)
title:  NanoAOD: accept unseeded e/gamma trigger
        objects in the Photon TrigObj selection
from:   santanumahata:nano-photon-trigobj-unseeded
        (aebf3eb64 on top of master ed35654b1)
to:     cms-sw:master, xpog signature
cites:  PR 40711 (bits added), PR 41827 (electrons
fixed)
backport: CMSSW_15_0_X if another production is
planned
```

- Status: the PR branch nano-photon-trigobj-unseeded (aebf3eb64) and the fork branch are on santanumahata/cmssw; no pull request exists; cms-sw/cmssw is untouched.
- Next action is yours: open the pull request from the GitHub web interface.

## Follow-ups, each a separate pull request

- Add the 2023 names of the Diphoton30_18 filters as OR alternatives inside bits 18 and 19 (keeps the numbering stable; the unseeded one needs this collection fix to work).
- Move bit 8 (hltHtEcal800) out of the Photon list, or drop it: its objects are HT objects.
- State in the documentation string which menus each bit covers, and review the stale bits per year (WPLoose, triple-electron, DeepTau overlaps, pixel-only jet filters, DeepCSV, DeepJet).
- Photon bits for the low-mass eta1p5, DiphotonMVA14p25, Diphoton15_1x EBEB and DoublePhoton paths, with the EGM POG and the Higgs PAG.
- Tell XPOG that MET trigger objects are never written and that the BoostedTau table was empty in v12 to v14.

# Appendix A: photon filter bits 0 to 10 (master numbering) and where their filters exist

| bit v15 | bit v12 to v14 | filter | objects come from | filter exists in menus |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 | 0 | hltEG33L1EG26HEFilter | hltEgammaCandidates | 2018 to 2026 |
| 1 | 1 | hltEG50HEFilter | hltEgammaCandidates | 2018 to 2026 |
| 2 | 2 | hltEG75HEFilter | hltEgammaCandidates | 2018 to 2026 |
| 3 | 3 | hltEG90HEFilter | hltEgammaCandidates | 2018 to 2026 |
| 4 | 4 | hltEG120HEFilter | hltEgammaCandidates | 2018 to 2026 |
| 5 | 5 | hltEG150HEFilter | hltEgammaCandidates | 2018 to 2026 |
| 6 | 6 | hltEG175HEFilter | hltEgammaCandidates | 2018 to 2026 |
| 7 | 7 | hltEG200HEFilter | hltEgammaCandidates | 2018 to 2026 |
| 8 | 8 | hltHtEcal800 | hltHtMhtEcal (HT object, type 89): never a photon | 2018 to 2026 |
| 9 | none | hltEG45EBTightIDTightIsoTrackIsoFilter | hltEgammaCandidates | 2024 to 2026 |
| 10 | none | hltEG50EBTightIDTightIsoTrackIsoFilter | hltEgammaCandidates | 2023 to 2026 |

Source: PhysicsTools/NanoAOD/python/triggerObjects_cff.py at master ed35654b1 (21 entries) and CMSSW_13_3_1_patch1 (18 entries); menu presence from the frozen 2018 to 2026 menus listed on the menus slide. "Objects come from" is the l1EGCand (or htLabels) of the module in the menu.

# Appendix B: photon filter bits 11 to 20, with the three dead unseeded entries

| v15 | v12 to v14 | filter | objects come from | filter exists in |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 11 | 9 | `hltEG110EBTightIDTightIsoTrackIsoFilter` | hltEgammaCandidates | 2018 to 2026 |
| 12 | 10 | `hltEG120EBTightIDTightIsoTrackIsoFilter` | hltEgammaCandidates | 2018, 2022 v1.2 only |
| 13 | 11 | `hltMu17Photon30IsoCaloIdPhotonlegTrackIsoFilter` | hltEgammaCandidates | 2018 to 2026 |
| 14 | 12 | `hltEG30LR9Id85b90eHE12R9Id50b80eR9IdLastFilter` | hltEgammaCandidates | 2018 to 2026 |
| 15 | 13 | `hltEG30LIso60CaloId15b35eHE12R9Id50b80e EcalIsoLastFilter` | hltEgammaCandidates | 2018 to 2026 |
| 16 | 14 | `hltEG22Iso60CaloId15b35eHE12R9Id50b80e TrackIsoUnseededLastFilter` | hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded, never set | 2018 to 2026 |
| 17 | 15 | `hltEG22R9Id85b90eHE12R9Id50b80e R9UnseededLastFilter` | hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded, never set | 2018 to 2026 |
| 18 | 16 | `hltEG30Iso60CaloId15b35eR9Id50b90e HE12b10eR9Id50b80eEcalIsoFilter` | hltEgammaCandidates | 2018, 2022 (renamed 2023) |
| 19 | 17 | `hltEG18TrackIso60Iso60CaloId15b35eR9Id50b90e HE12b10eR9Id50b80eTrackIsoUnseededFilter` | hltEgammaCandidatesUnseeded, never set | 2018, 2022 (renamed 2023) |
| 20 | none | `hltEG*L1VBFLooseIsoEGHEFilter (only hltEG22L1VBFLooseIsoEGHEFilter)` | hltEgammaCandidates | 2023 to 2026 |

Long module names are broken over two lines for display only. Decimal values of the dead bits: 65536, 131072, 524288 (v15 and master); 16384, 32768, 131072 (v12 to v14).

# Appendix C: how the defect was born, survived and was found

**7 to 8 Feb 2023**

**PR 40711** adds the six diphoton photon bits for the next NanoAOD production. The Photon selection is not touched, so the three unseeded bits are dead from day one. In CMSSW_13_0_0; v12 is made with 13_0_13.

**31 May to 8 Jun 2023**

**PR 41827** gives the Electron selection the unseeded collection and the CaloIdL_MW unseeded bit. Photons are not revisited. In CMSSW_13_3_0, so NanoAOD v13 has it for electrons only.

**Nov to Dec 2023**

**13_3_X backports** for v13 (43292 from 43247, 43286, 43470 and others); CMSSW_13_3_1_patch1 produces NanoAOD v13 for Summer22, 22EE, 23, 23BPix MC and the 16Dec2023 2022 data.

**13 to 18 Mar 2025**

**PR 47594 / 47601**: hltEG45 and hltEG50 EB bits and the VBF wildcard are added and filterBits becomes 64-bit (CMSSW_15_0_2). The unseeded bits move to 16, 17 and 19, still dead. v15 inherits them.

**4 Nov 2026**

**This investigation**: cause located, confirmed on master ed35654b1 and the 16_x branches, whole-table scan done, one-line fix committed on top of upstream master, pull request text ready. No open upstream PR or issue on the subject.

Dates are the creation and merge dates returned by the GitHub search API. Between CMSSW_13_0_0 and 13_0_1 the photon pt threshold moved from 20 to 15 GeV; that change did not touch the collection test either.